

adapting to FBML. To distinguish between HTML and FBML commands in your application code, you need to prefix FBML tags with `fb:` as you would if you were using multiple DTDs/schemas in XHTML.

For example, if you want to add a link to your application's about page on your dashboard, all you need is to add the following lines of code in your application:

```
<fb:dashboard>
  <fb:about href="about.php">About the Application</
fb:about>
</fb:dashboard>
```

## 1.2 FQL (Facebook Query Language)

FQL stands for Facebook Query Language. It offers a lot of SQL-like features and language elements that allow applications to directly query Facebook's internal data tables. FQL uses the same syntax as typical ANSI-SQL, so if you've worked with SQL before, FQL isn't a big deal. FQL is powerful in the sense that it accesses and returns the same data provided by many of the Facebook API calls; however, it allows applications to have Facebook filter that data with a language of your choice before it's returned to the client, which potentially speeds up page loading and response times.

For example, if you want the name, and birthday of all of your friends, then you can use the following query in the API Test Console:

```
SELECT first_name, last_name, birthday
FROM user
WHERE uid IN (  SELECT uid1
                 FROM friend
                 WHERE uid2=1234646)
```

Don't forget to replace our ID (1234646) with your own because you can only use the details of friends of the logged in user. We are still using the API, but only one method—`fql.query`. This basically means that you're not limited to the information supplied by the API methods and the FBML tags. You can actually extract the exact data that you want with whatever language you are using.

## 1.3 FBJS (Facebook JavaScript)

FBJS is the Facebook's version of JavaScript for developers who really want, or need, to use JavaScript in their applications. Facebook scrubs (removes) much of the JavaScript you add to your application to minimise the threat of cross-site scripting (XSS) attacks, but by using Facebook JavaScript (FBJS)